

DATA72000 - Extended Research Project: Guidance for the Presentation of Reports

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1. INTRODUCTION

This document gives guidance on the presentation of Extended Research Project Reports for DATA72000. The University's '[Policy on Submission of Work for Summative Assessment on Taught Programmes](#)' states that *"all typed summative assessment, including dissertations, should be submitted online and subjected to plagiarism detection software, where appropriate"* and that *"Schools may specify instances where the use of online submission and/or plagiarism detection software is inappropriate. Details of the alternative arrangements in these specific instances must be published to students"*. **The expectation is therefore that Research Project Reports are produced and submitted electronically.** However, should a School consider online submission inappropriate and require the hard copy binding of reports, the costs of doing so must be borne by the School concerned and students must be made aware of the requirement.

2. GENERAL INFORMATION

- 2.1. All reports must be written in English. Quotations, however, may be given in the language in which they were written.
- 2.2. A short (no more than 300 words) abstract of a report must be provided.
- 2.3. Students must ensure that material in reports that is taken from another source is appropriately referenced and not, intentionally or otherwise, presented as their own original work. Material that is taken from other sources and not correctly referenced will be investigated by the University to make sure that it is not the result of cheating or other academic malpractice. Information on academic malpractice and its consideration by the University, including guidance for students, is available at:
<http://www.staffnet.manchester.ac.uk/tlso/policy-guidance/assessment/process-of-assessment/academic-malpractice/>
Students must ensure that material in reports is free of any copyright restrictions. Guidance on copyright is available here:
<http://subjects.library.manchester.ac.uk/copyright/students>
- 2.4. It is the student's responsibility to ensure that the report is checked for typographical errors. Anybody involved with proofreading a report should be checking solely for grammatical/spelling errors. The University statement on proofreading is available at:
<http://documents.manchester.ac.uk/display.aspx?DocID=23469>.
- 2.5. Students must ensure that they are familiar with any local regulations on word count and be aware of the penalties that will be subject to if they do not adhere to them.

3. FORMATTING

- 3.1 For the main text, **double or 1.5 spacing** with a minimum font size of 12 must be used; single-spacing may be used for quotations, footnotes and references.
- 3.2 General guidance on bibliographic citations and references can be obtained from the programme director and must be consistent throughout the report. However, there is no set format stipulated.
- 3.3 Page numbering must consist of one single sequence of Arabic numerals (ie 1, 2, 3 ...) throughout the report. Page numbers must be displayed on all pages **EXCEPT** the title page, though this is counted as page one. The pagination sequence will include not only the text of the report but also the preliminary pages, diagrams, tables, figures, illustrations, appendices, references etc. Roman numerals **must not** be used for page numbering.
- 3.4 The main text of the report should normally be left-justified to aid accessibility and readability.
- 3.5 Figures or images used in the report must be of sufficient size and clarity.

4. REQUIRED PAGES

The following items (a-g) **must** be included as preliminary pages of the report **in the order given**.

a. TITLE PAGE

A title page giving:

- i. the full title of the report;
- ii. a statement as follows: 'A report submitted to The University of Manchester for the degree of xxx (Title of the degree, e.g. Master of Arts)¹ in the Faculty of xxx (Name of the Faculty)²;
- iii. the year of submission (*not including the month*);
- iv. the candidate's student ID number; and
- v. the name of the candidate's School.

Please refer to Section 5 for a sample title page.

Extended research project reports which were referred for re-examination must bear the year of **resubmission** on the title-page and not the year of the original submission.

¹ Details of the titles of degrees can be found within the University's General Regulations: [General Regulations](#) (page 17: Regulation XI – Titles of Degrees and other Distinctions)

² Details of the University's Faculty and School titles can be found on the website: [University structure](#)

b. LIST OF CONTENTS

A list of contents, giving all relevant sub-divisions of the report and a page number for each item.

The final word count, including footnotes and endnotes, MUST be inserted at the bottom of the contents page.

c. OTHER LISTS

Lists of tables, figures, diagrams, photographs, abbreviations etc. If a report contains tables it is recommended that a separate list of each item, as appropriate, is provided **immediately after the contents page(s)**. Such lists **must** give the page number of each item on the list.

d. ABSTRACT

A short abstract describing the contents of the report. This should be short (not more than 300 words), with emphasis on major observations and deductions rather than on methods. It must be designed to be read independently of the rest of the report and references to the report and other literature will not normally be included.

e. DECLARATION

A declaration stating that the report is the student's original work unless referenced clearly to the contrary, and:

EITHER: that no portion of the work referred to in the report has been submitted in support of an application for another degree or qualification of this or any other university or other institute of learning;

OR: what portion of the work referred to in the report has been submitted in support of an application for another degree or qualification of this or any other university or other institute of learning.

f. INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY STATEMENT

All **four** of the following notes on copyright and the ownership of intellectual property rights must be included as written below:

- i.** The author of this report (including any appendices and/or schedules to this report) owns certain copyright or related rights in it (the "Copyright") and s/he has given The University of Manchester certain rights to use such Copyright, including for administrative purposes.
- ii.** Copies of this report, either in full or in extracts and whether in hard or electronic copy, may be made **only** in accordance with the Copyright, Designs and Patents Act 1988 (as amended) and regulations issued under it or, where appropriate, in accordance with licensing agreements which the University has entered into. This page must form part of any such copies made.

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- iii. The ownership of certain Copyright, patents, designs, trademarks and other intellectual property (the “Intellectual Property”) and any reproductions of copyright works in the report, for example graphs and tables (“Reproductions”), which may be described in this report, may not be owned by the author and may be owned by third parties. Such Intellectual Property and Reproductions cannot and must not be made available for use without the prior written permission of the owner(s) of the relevant Intellectual Property and/or Reproductions.
- iv. Further information on the conditions under which disclosure, publication and commercialisation of this report, the Copyright and any Intellectual Property and/or Reproductions described in it may take place is available in the [University IP Policy](#), in any relevant Report restriction declarations deposited in the University Library, and The [University Library’s regulations](#).

g. AI STATEMENT

Please insert a description of your use of AI in developing the research, conducting the research, or writing the report. A short paragraph summarising your use is sufficient here. If you have not used AI at all then write here “AI was not used at any point in the research conducted nor in the writing of this report”.

Note if you have used AI as a tool in the conduct of the research this should also be described in the methods section of the report. Details that are needed for reproducibility purposes should be included in the additional materials.

h. OTHER PAGES (not compulsory)

The preliminary pages may also include dedications, acknowledgements and similar. These must appear after the compulsory pages. Short items may be combined on the same page.

It is helpful if a brief statement is included giving the candidate’s degree(s) and relevant experience, even if the latter consists only of the work done for this report. This may be untitled or it may be headed ‘Preface’ or ‘The Author’ or similar.

5. SAMPLE TITLE PAGE

TITLE OF REPORT

A report submitted to The University of Manchester for the degree of in the
Faculty of xxx

i. YEAR OF SUBMISSION

j. (OR YEAR OF RESUBMISSION)

STUDENT ID NUMBER

CANDIDATE'S SCHOOL

6. REPORT SUBMISSION CHECKLIST

PLEASE NOTE THE FOLLOWING:

The staff in the School Office may use the following checklist to ensure all instructions detailed in these Guidance Notes have been adhered to when accepting reports.

If any section is missing, out of order or not correct, the report may be rejected. (The School may accept the incorrect version for examination but inform the student that no result will be released until a properly completed version has been submitted after the examination process has been finalised).

It is the candidate's responsibility to ensure that the instructions are followed exactly.

If a candidate is unsure about any aspect of the presentation of the report, he or she must contact the relevant School Office for advice.

k. Preface pages should be in the following order:

Title Page – see Section 5

All of these should be included:

- Title of report
- Official Wording – see section 4 (a)
- Correct Faculty
- Year of Submission (or Resubmission)
- Candidate's Student ID number
- School

l. Contents Page

(including any list of tables/figures etc)

Page numbers given for each listing

m. Abstract

Declaration

Copyright

(this may go on the same page as the Declaration)

Pagination

All pages must be numbered;
page numbers must be displayed
on all pages, except the title page

Guidance for the Presentation of Taught Dissertations for UG and PGT Provision

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